SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

9 June 2022 · Shift 2

79 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 21 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 22 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the following sentence. You have made only “perfunctory” attempts to understand me!

(A) adamant
(B) careful
(C) basic
(D) casual

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Imprisonment

(A) Incapacitation
(B) Incarceration
(C) Inarch
(D) Imputation

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Hit the sack

(A) Miss the mark
(B) Confirm the target
(C) Complete the assignment
(D) Go to sleep

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Hallucinate
(B) Hiatus
(C) Sacrilage
(D) Launderette

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. In queer street

(A) Among scoundrels
(B) In prison
(C) Lost your way
(D) In debt

Q.7

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. When we got / to the train station, / the Rajdhani Express / had already been leaving.

(A) the Rajdhani Express
(B) When we got
(C) had already been leaving
(D) to the train station

Q.8

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The students / and the teachers / worked hardly / to make the event a success.

(A) and their teachers
(B) worked hardly
(C) The students
(D) to make the event a success

Q.9

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. I “guessed her feelings” when she started crying.

(A) estimated her emotions
(B) estimated her rejoinders
(C) estimated her reactions
(D) estimated her ripostes

Q.10

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. His friends arranged for the ambulance and took him immediately to the hospital.

(A) His friends would have arranged for the ambulance and taken him immediately to the hospital.
(B) His friends were arranged for the ambulance and taken him immediately to the hospital.
(C) The ambulance arranged for his friends and took him immediately to the hospital.
(D) The ambulance was arranged for by his friends and he was immediately taken to the hospital.

Q.11

Complete the collocation. When we met first it was very difficult to _____ the ice.

(A) smash
(B) burst
(C) break
(D) shatter

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Tagore and Gandhi were undoubtedly the two outstanding and _____ figures of India in the first half of twentieth century.

(A) dominating
(B) activating
(C) resuming
(D) appreciating

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. Raman is finding it difficult to adjust as he “has come to a different country from his own country for settling”

(A) Pilgrim
(B) Immigrant
(C) Globetrotter
(D) Gypsy

Q.15

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A.They also resolved to impose restrictions on the Russian central bank's ability to access and deploy the country's 'war chest' of an estimated $630 billion in foreign exchange reserves. B.Saturday's announcement by the US, the UK and European allies, including France and Germany, of a raft of 'further restrictive economic measures' to increase the costs on Russia for its invasion of Ukraine has just raised the risks of a more widespread economic fallout from this war. C.The immediate impact of these moves on Russia's economy and financial markets have manifested in a sharp depreciation in the value of the Rouble. D.With a view to further isolating Russia from the international financial system, the Western allies decided to block 'selected' Russian banks from the SWIFT messaging system that banks and financial institutions use to validate and complete international payment transactions.

(A) BDAC
(B) BACD
(C) ABCD
(D) DBAC

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Defile

(A) Regularize
(B) Labor
(C) Particularize
(D) Purify

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Exorcise

(A) Invent
(B) Expel
(C) Introduce
(D) Expect

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Who is talking “in” the phone?

(A) for
(B) on
(C) with
(D) at

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the following sentence. You can sleep here but this bed is “squalid” and wet.

(A) disorderly
(B) uncomfortable
(C) clean
(D) painful

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Union Budget, 2018-19, has proposed to treat school education holistically without (1)_____ from pre-nursery to Class 12. Samagra Shiksha - an overarching programme for the school education sector extending from pre-school to class 12 has been, therefore, (2) _____ with the broader goal of improving school effectiveness measured in terms of equal opportunities (3) _____ schooling and equitable learning outcomes. The Goal SDG-4.1 states that, “By 2030, ensure that all boys and girls complete free, equitable and quality primary and secondary education (4) _____ to relevant and effective learning outcomes”. Further the SDG 4.5 states that, “By 2030, eliminate gender (5)_____ in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill blank 1.

(A) attachment
(B) segmentation
(C) accord
(D) agreement

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Union Budget, 2018-19, has proposed to treat school education holistically without (1)_____ from pre-nursery to Class 12. Samagra Shiksha - an overarching programme for the school education sector extending from pre-school to class 12 has been, therefore, (2) _____ with the broader goal of improving school effectiveness measured in terms of equal opportunities (3) _____ schooling and equitable learning outcomes. The Goal SDG-4.1 states that, “By 2030, ensure that all boys and girls complete free, equitable and quality primary and secondary education (4) _____ to relevant and effective learning outcomes”. Further the SDG 4.5 states that, “By 2030, eliminate gender (5)_____ in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill blank 2.

(A) prepared
(B) prepares
(C) preparing
(D) prepare

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Union Budget, 2018-19, has proposed to treat school education holistically without (1)_____ from pre-nursery to Class 12. Samagra Shiksha - an overarching programme for the school education sector extending from pre-school to class 12 has been, therefore, (2) _____ with the broader goal of improving school effectiveness measured in terms of equal opportunities (3) _____ schooling and equitable learning outcomes. The Goal SDG-4.1 states that, “By 2030, ensure that all boys and girls complete free, equitable and quality primary and secondary education (4) _____ to relevant and effective learning outcomes”. Further the SDG 4.5 states that, “By 2030, eliminate gender (5)_____ in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill blank 3.

(A) for
(B) to
(C) on
(D) at

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Union Budget, 2018-19, has proposed to treat school education holistically without (1)_____ from pre-nursery to Class 12. Samagra Shiksha - an overarching programme for the school education sector extending from pre-school to class 12 has been, therefore, (2) _____ with the broader goal of improving school effectiveness measured in terms of equal opportunities (3) _____ schooling and equitable learning outcomes. The Goal SDG-4.1 states that, “By 2030, ensure that all boys and girls complete free, equitable and quality primary and secondary education (4) _____ to relevant and effective learning outcomes”. Further the SDG 4.5 states that, “By 2030, eliminate gender (5)_____ in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill blank 4.

(A) to be leading
(B) leading
(C) leads
(D) lead

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Union Budget, 2018-19, has proposed to treat school education holistically without (1)_____ from pre-nursery to Class 12. Samagra Shiksha - an overarching programme for the school education sector extending from pre-school to class 12 has been, therefore, (2) _____ with the broader goal of improving school effectiveness measured in terms of equal opportunities (3) _____ schooling and equitable learning outcomes. The Goal SDG-4.1 states that, “By 2030, ensure that all boys and girls complete free, equitable and quality primary and secondary education (4) _____ to relevant and effective learning outcomes”. Further the SDG 4.5 states that, “By 2030, eliminate gender (5)_____ in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill blank 5.

(A) agreement
(B) harmony
(C) similarity
(D) disparities

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Two statements are given followed by two conclusions numbered I and II. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All sparrows are peacocks. Some peacocks are birds. Conclusions: I. All birds are sparrow. II. Some sparrows are not birds.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.2

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and fourth term is related to third term. PLANK : RMDOM :: TABLE : VBEMG :: ZEBRA : ?

(A) BEFSC
(B) CFESC
(C) BFESC
(D) CEFSC

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 34 : 169 :: 42 : 209 :: 28 : ?

(A) 119
(B) 139
(C) 109
(D) 129

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the sixth term is related to the fifth term. 8 : 48 :: 19 : ? :: 16 : 112

(A) 136
(B) 142
(C) 145
(D) 138

Q.6

If 31 August 2000 was Friday, then what was the day of the week on 31 August 2009?

(A) Monday
(B) Tuesday
(C) Wednesday
(D) Friday

Q.7

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 14*11*97*67*10

(A) +,−,=,×
(B) ×,−,=,+
(C) ×,−,=,−
(D) +,=,−,×

Q.10

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row: 58,−28,−90; Second row: −17, 21,−12; Third row: −8,−7, ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the number into its constituent digits. For example, 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 38
(B) 45
(C) −40
(D) −35

Q.11

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 4328 : 8324
(B) 2437 : 7342
(C) 3569 : 9653
(D) 1786 : 6871

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'you can do' is written as 'mat hat pat', 'They can work' is written as 'rat pat ant' and 'they do think' is written as 'ant hat cat'. How will 'Think' be written in that language?

(A) mat
(B) pat
(C) cat
(D) ant

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'PIZZA' is written as 'PZZIA' and 'CHEESE' is written as 'CSEEHE'. How will 'PASTA' be written in that language?

(A) PTSTA
(B) PTASA
(C) PSTAA
(D) PTSAA

Q.15

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 9, 12, 21, 36, 57, 84, ?

(A) 171
(B) 117
(C) 172
(D) 127

Q.16

In a certain code language, “SUIT” is written as “SITU”, and “CUTE” is written as “CTEU”. How will “WASH” be written in that language?

(A) WHAS
(B) WSHA
(C) WSAH
(D) HAWS

Q.17

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation.
79 * 2 * 58 * 2 * 14 * 143

(A) –, +, ÷, ×, =
(B) ÷, ×, –, +, =
(C) ×, –, ÷, +, =
(D) ÷, ×, +, –, =

Q.18

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? AXUV, ?, YZWT, XAXS, WBYR

(A) ZYVU
(B) CZSV
(C) BZVW
(D) XWUV

Q.19

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and fourth term related to third term. 7689 : 120 :: 6178 : 88 :: 3284 : ?

(A) 68
(B) 70
(C) 69
(D) 75

Q.20

Select the option that represents the letters that, when sequentially placed from left to right in the blanks below, will complete the letter series. p _ r _ p o _ p o r b _ o _ p o r b _ o r

(A) o b p p o p
(B) o b o p r p
(C) o b r p r o
(D) o b r p r p

Q.22

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row: 32, 51, 33; Second row: 28, 33, 25; Third row: 16, 27, ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the number into its constituent digits. For example, 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 19
(B) 17
(C) 15
(D) 18

Q.24

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1. Hypocrisy 2. Hilarious 3. Humidity 4. Highlight 5. Hallucinate

(A) 5,2,4,3,1
(B) 5,3,4,2,1
(C) 5,4,2,3,1
(D) 5,4,3,2,1

Quantitative Aptitude 14 questions

Q.1

The difference between a discount of 35% and two successive discounts of 20% and 20% on a certain bill, was ₹22. Find the amount of the bill.

(A) ₹2,800
(B) ₹2,200
(C) ₹3,200
(D) ₹2,000

Q.2

Riya runs 3/2 times as fast as Prerna. In a race, if Riya gives a lead of 100 m to Prerna, find the distance Riya has to run before both of them meet.

(A) 315 m
(B) 300 m
(C) 265 m
(D) 240 m

Q.6

A shopkeeper sold an article for ₹1,326 after allowing a discount of 15% on its marked price. Find the marked price of the article.

(A) ₹1,153
(B) ₹ 1,560
(C) ₹1,525
(D) ₹1,650

Q.7

If $(x + 2)$ and $(x – 3)$ are the factors of $x^2 + k_1x + k_2$, then:

(A) $k_1 = 1$ and $k_2 = –6$
(B) $k_1 = –1$ and $k_2 = –6$
(C) $k_1 = –1$ and $k_2 = 6$
(D) $k_1 = 1$ and $k_2 = 6$

Q.8

In a right circular cone, the radius of the base is 14 cm and the height is 48 cm. A cross-section is made through the midpoint of the height parallel to the base. The volume of the upper portion is: (Take π=22/7)

(A) 1102 cm^3
(B) 1232 cm^3
(C) 1120 cm^3
(D) 1442 cm^3

Q.9

On a sum of money, when invested for 2 years, compound interest and simple interest are ₹300 and ₹250, respectively. For both simple and compound interests the rate of interest per annum is the same, and for compound interest, interest is compounded annually. Find the rate of interest per annum.

(A) 10%
(B) 20%
(C) 40%
(D) 30%

Q.10

Find the greatest possible value of (a + b) for which the 8-digit number 143b203a is divisible by 15.

(A) 15
(B) 17
(C) 16
(D) 14

Q.12

P, Q and R are batsmen. The ratio of the runs scored by them in a certain match was P : Q = 16 : 17 and Q : R = 15 : 16. At the end of the match, they scored a total of 956 runs. The number of runs scored by R is (nearest to an integer):

(A) 440
(B) 335
(C) 339
(D) 430

Q.14

The average weight of 8 men is increased by 1.5 kg when one of the men who weighs 65kg is replaced by a new man. The weight of the new man is:

(A) 71 kg
(B) 87 kg
(C) 81 kg
(D) 77 kg

Q.16

There is a continuous growth in the population of a village at the rate of 5% per annum. If its present population is 18522, what was the population of the village 3 years ago?

(A) 17500
(B) 16400
(C) 16000
(D) 17200

Q.17

If 15 boys earn ₹900 in 5 days, then how much will 20 boys earn in 7 days?

(A) ₹1,580
(B) ₹1,680
(C) ₹1,540
(D) ₹1,650

Q.19

The expenditure of a company increases by 25%, then increases by 30%, then further decreases by 20%.The overall percentage change in expenditure is:

(A) 10
(B) 30
(C) 34
(D) 22

Q.22

By using faulty weight, a shopkeeper cheats to the extent of 6% while buying and selling rice. Find his gain percentage (rounded to two decimal places).

(A) 14.66%
(B) 13.65%
(C) 12.77%
(D) 11.25%

Q.25

Find the total surface area of a cylinder with diameter of base 28 cm and height 70 cm. (Take π=22/7)

(A) 7300 cm^2
(B) 7932 cm^2
(C) 8000 cm^2
(D) 7392 cm^2

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

M S Subbulakshmi, a legend in India is known for which of the following?

(A) Ghazal music
(B) Hindustani music
(C) Sufi devotional music
(D) Carnatic music

Q.2

Which term is used to describe all living communities on earth, including animals, plants, bacteria, fungi and photosynthetic microbes?

(A) Biosphere
(B) Community
(C) Habitat
(D) Biome

Q.3

'Waiting for A Visa' is a famous autobiography of _____.

(A) Swami Acchutanand
(B) Dr. BR Ambedkar
(C) Babu Jagjivan Ram
(D) MC Rajah

Q.4

Who among the following personalities along with his sons played 'Raga for Peace' in the year 2014 at the 'Nobel Peace Prize Concert'?

(A) Pandit Ram Narayan
(B) Ustad Bismillah Khan
(C) Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia
(D) Ustad Amjad Ali Khan

Q.5

Who is the author of the historical novel 'Twilight in Delhi'?

(A) Ahmed Ali
(B) Amrita Pritam
(C) Khushwant Singh
(D) Krishna Sobti

Q.6

Lalgudi Gopala Iyer Jayaraman used to play which of the following instruments?

(A) Harmonium
(B) Flute
(C) Mridangam
(D) Violin

Q.7

'Sea of Poppies' is a novel written by which of the following writers?

(A) Amitav Ghosh
(B) Shashi Tharoor
(C) Manohar Malgonkar
(D) Anuj Dhar

Q.8

Which Article of the Indian Constitution deals with the definition of the Money Bill?

(A) Article 120
(B) Article 100
(C) Article 115
(D) Article 110

Q.9

_____ was established between informal groups (SHGs) and formal financial institutions (banks) for catering to the financial needs of the poor.

(A) SHG–Bank linkage
(B) SIDBI–MFI linkage
(C) NABARD–Bank linkage
(D) SHG–NABARD linkage

Q.10

Hydroelectric power stations generate electricity by using the force of water that falls into the turbines and spins the shaft. By rotating the shaft of the turbine, the potential energy of water is converted into _____ energy.

(A) chemical
(B) thermal
(C) gravitational
(D) kinetic

Q.11

Which is the highest peak in peninsular India?

(A) K2
(B) Anai Mudi
(C) Kangchenjunga
(D) Kamet

Q.12

Padma Shri awardee Ileana Citaristi, an Italy born Indian dance exponent was conferred the award for her major contribution to which of the following dances?

(A) Manipuri
(B) Bharatanatyam
(C) Kathak
(D) Odissi

Q.13

In 1838, who published an article discussing the structure and origin of plant cells?

(A) Robert Brown
(B) Rudolf Virchow
(C) Matthias Schleiden
(D) Albert von Kölliker

Q.14

The famous singer Jagjit Singh is known for which of the following genres?

(A) Ghazal
(B) Bhajan
(C) Carnatic music
(D) Hindustani music

Q.15

The Men's World Boxing Championship 2023 will be hosted by which of the following countries?

(A) Uzbekistan
(B) Turkmenistan
(C) Kyrgyzstan
(D) Tajikistan

Q.16

_____ was awarded the title of Hanjaba by the Maharaja of Manipur and the Sangit Natak Akademi Award in 1966.

(A) Guru Amubi Singh
(B) Rajkumar Singhajit Singh
(C) Guru Bipin Singh
(D) Sougaijam Thanil Singh

Q.17

In July 2021, Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel was appointed as the Governor of _____.

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Karnataka
(D) Kerala

Q.18

What is the name of the zone where trade winds converge?

(A) Forest zone
(B) Intra-terrestrial zone
(C) Inter-continental convergence zone
(D) Inter-tropical convergence zone

Q.19

_____ was the first woman dancer to receive the Padma Vibhushan, the nation's second-highest civilian award.

(A) Mrinalini Sarabhai
(B) Padma Subramaniyam
(C) Tanjore Balasaraswati
(D) Alarmel Valli

Q.20

Who among the following was awarded the Dhyan Chand Award for Lifetime achievement in Sports and Games 2021 in Boxing discipline?

(A) Gurcharan Singh
(B) Lekha KC
(C) Akhil Kumar
(D) Devendro Singh

Q.21

Who found out the relationship between the current I flowing in a metallic wire and the potential difference across its terminals?

(A) Albert Einstein
(B) Georg Simon Ohm
(C) Rutherford
(D) Niels Bohr

Q.22

As of August 2021, which Indian state organises Qila Raipur Sports Festival, also known as India's Rural Olympics, annually?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Punjab
(C) Haryana
(D) Rajasthan

Q.23

In the early 1980s, an aspartic acid-containing dipeptide sweetener was discovered, that was about 2000 times sweeter than sucrose. What is the name of that sweetener?

(A) Alitame
(B) Saccharin
(C) Aspartame
(D) Sucralose

Q.24

US-based Bharatanatyam/Kuchipudi exponent _____ has won the prestigious Abhinandan Saroja National Award 2021 by the National Institute of Indian Classical Dance at Samarpan on November 15th 2021.

(A) Jeeno Joseph
(B) Aparna Satheesan
(C) Carol Kuruvilla
(D) Sharan Lowen

Q.25

In which sport is the equipment called antenna used?

(A) Volleyball
(B) Base ball
(C) Basketball
(D) Hockey

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**
Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**		

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**
Q.10 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.22 **(C)**	Q.25 **(D)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (B) careful

'Perfunctory' means done carelessly, as a mere formality; its opposite is 'careful'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Incarceration

'Incarceration' is confinement in prison: imprisonment.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Go to sleep

To 'hit the sack' is to go to bed: to go to sleep.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Sacrilage

The correct spelling is 'sacrilege'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) In debt

To be 'in queer street' is to be in debt or in financial difficulty.

Q.7 · Answer (C) had already been leaving

An action completed before another past action takes the past perfect: 'the Rajdhani Express had already left'.

Q.8 · Answer (B) worked hardly

'Hardly' means scarcely; the adverb meaning 'with great effort' is 'hard': 'worked hard'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) estimated her emotions

SSC's key gives 'estimated her emotions', the only option that keeps the sense of 'feelings': 'rejoinders' and 'ripostes' are replies, and 'reactions' changes the meaning. The sentence as printed is already correct ('guessed' fits better than 'estimated'), but there is no 'no improvement' option.

Q.10 · Answer (D) The ambulance was arranged for by his friends and he was immediately taken to the hospital.

'Arranged for' becomes 'was arranged for by' and 'took him' becomes 'he was taken': 'The ambulance was arranged for by his friends and he was immediately taken to the hospital.'

Q.11 · Answer (C) break

'Break the ice' is the set phrase: to ease the first awkwardness between people who have just met.

Q.12 · Answer (A) dominating

Tagore and Gandhi were 'dominating' figures, the most influential of their time; the other words do not describe a person's standing.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Immigrant

An immigrant comes to live permanently in a foreign country; a pilgrim travels to a holy place and a globetrotter travels widely.

Q.15 · Answer (A) BDAC

B announces the new measures, D gives the first (cutting banks off from SWIFT), A adds another with 'also', and C describes their immediate impact: BDAC.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Purify

To 'defile' is to make dirty or impure; its opposite is to 'purify'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Expel

To 'exorcise' an evil spirit is to drive it out: to 'expel' it.

Q.18 · Answer (B) on

One talks 'on' the phone: 'Who is talking on the phone?'

Q.19 · Answer (C) clean

'Squalid' means dirty and unpleasant; its opposite is 'clean'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) segmentation
The plan treats school education as one whole, 'without segmentation' into separate stages from pre-nursery to Class 12.

Q.22 · Answer (A) prepared
The present perfect passive 'has been prepared' needs the past participle.

Q.23 · Answer (A) for
'Equal opportunities for schooling': 'opportunity' takes 'for'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) leading
Education 'leading to' relevant learning outcomes: the participle describes the education.

Q.25 · Answer (D) disparities
The goal is to 'eliminate gender disparities in education', that is remove inequalities, as 'ensure equal access' confirms.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
Some peacocks are birds, but nothing ties birds to sparrows, so neither 'all birds are sparrows' (I) nor 'some sparrows are not birds' (II) must be true. Neither follows.

Q.2 · Answer (C) BFESC
The letters move +2, +1, +3, +1, +2: PLANK → RMDOM and TABLE → VBEMG. So ZEBRA → BFESC (Z wraps round to B).

Q.4 · Answer (B) 139
The second number is five times the first minus 1: 34 × 5 − 1 = 169 and 42 × 5 − 1 = 209. Likewise 28 × 5 − 1 = 139.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 136
The second number is 8 times (the first minus 2): 8 × 6 = 48 and 8 × 14 = 112. Likewise 8 × 17 = 136.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Tuesday
From 31 August 2000 to 31 August 2009 is 9 years, two of them (taking in 29 February 2004 and 2008) leap years: 9 + 2 = 11 odd days, that is 4. Friday + 4 = Tuesday.

Q.7 · Answer (C) ×,−,=,−
14 × 11 − 97 = 154 − 97 = 57, and 67 − 10 = 57.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 45
In each row the third number is −3 times the sum of the first two: (58 − 28) × (−3) = −90 and (−17 + 21) × (−3) = −12. So (−8 − 7) × (−3) = 45.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 4328 : 8324
In 2437 : 7342, 3569 : 9653 and 1786 : 6871 the digits are reversed. Reversed, 4328 would give 8234, not 8324, so it is the odd pair.

Q.12 · Answer (C) cat
'can' and 'pat' are common to the first two sentences, 'do' and 'hat' to the first and third, and 'they' and 'ant' to the second and third. That leaves think = cat.

Q.13 · Answer (D) PTSAA
The second letter and the second-last letter swap places: PIZZA → PZZIA and CHEESE → CSEEHE. In PASTA, A and T swap: PTSAA.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 117
The differences are 3, 9, 15, 21, 27, rising by 6 each time, so the next is 33: 84 + 33 = 117.

Q.16 · Answer (B) WSHA
The first letter stays and the second moves to the end: SUIT → SITU and CUTE → CTEU. So WASH → WSHA.

Q.17 · Answer (C) ×, –, ÷, +, =
79 × 2 – 58 ÷ 2 + 14 = 158 – 29 + 14 = 143.

Q.18 · Answer (A) ZYVU
First letters move back one (A, Z, Y, X, W), second letters forward one (X, Y, Z, A, B), third letters forward one (U, V, W, X, Y) and fourth letters back one (V, U, T, S, R). The missing cluster is ZYVU.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 68
The second number is four times the sum of the first number's digits: (7 + 6 + 8 + 9) × 4 = 120 and (6 + 1 + 7 + 8) × 4 = 88. Likewise (3 + 2 + 8 + 4) × 4 = 68.

Q.20 · Answer (D) o b r p r p
With o, b, r, p, r, p in the blanks the series reads porb por porb por porb por: 'porb' and 'por' alternate.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 17
In each row the third number is half the first plus a third of the second: 16 + 17 = 33 and 14 + 11 = 25. So 8 + 9 = 17.

Q.24 · Answer (C) 5,4,2,3,1
In dictionary order: Hallucinate (5), Highlight (4), Hilarious (2), Humidity (3), Hypocrisy (1). 'Ha' comes before 'Hi', 'Hig' before 'Hil', and 'Hu' before 'Hy'.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (B) ₹2,200
Two successive 20% discounts leave 0.8 × 0.8 = 0.64 of the bill, a 36% discount. The 1% difference from 35% is ₹22, so the bill is ₹2,200.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 300 m
In the time Riya runs d, Prerna runs d – 100, so d : (d – 100) = 3 : 2. Then 2d = 3d – 300 and d = 300 m.

Q.6 · Answer (B) ₹ 1,560
The selling price is 85% of the marked price: 1,326 ÷ 0.85 = ₹1,560.

Q.7 · Answer (B) $k_1 = -1$ and $k_2 = -6$
$(x + 2)(x – 3) = x^2 – x – 6$, so $k_1 = -1$ and $k_2 = -6$.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 1232 cm³
The upper portion is a cone of half the height and half the radius, 24 cm and 7 cm: V = (1/3) × (22/7) × 7² × 24 = 1,232 cm³.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 40%
Simple interest is ₹125 a year. Compound interest exceeds it by ₹50, the second year's interest on the first year's ₹125: 50/125 = 40%.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 14
Divisible by 5, a is 0 or 5; divisible by 3, the digit sum 13 + a + b must be a multiple of 3. With a = 5, 18 + b allows b = 9, so a + b = 14 (with a = 0, b is at most 8).

Q.12 · Answer (C) 339
P : Q : R = 16 × 15 : 17 × 15 : 17 × 16 = 240 : 255 : 272, 767 parts in all. R = 956 × 272/767 ≈ 339.02, so 339.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 77 kg
The total rises by 8 × 1.5 = 12 kg, so the new man weighs 65 + 12 = 77 kg.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 16000
Three years of 5% growth multiply the population by (21/20)³ = 9261/8000, so 3 years ago it was 18522 × 8000/9261 = 16000.

Q.17 · Answer (B) ₹1,680
Each boy earns 900 ÷ (15 × 5) = ₹12 a day, so 20 boys earn 20 × 7 × 12 = ₹1,680 in 7 days.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 30
1.25 × 1.30 × 0.80 = 1.30: an overall rise of 30%.

Q.22 · Answer (C) 12.77%
Buying, he takes 106 g for the price of 100 g; selling, he gives 94 g for the price of 100 g. Gain = (106 – 94)/94 × 100 = 12.77%.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 7392 cm²
TSA = 2πr(r + h) = 2 × (22/7) × 14 × (14 + 70) = 88 × 84 = 7,392 cm².

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Carnatic music
M. S. Subbulakshmi was a Carnatic vocalist and the first musician to receive the Bharat Ratna (1998).

Q.2 · Answer (A) Biosphere
The biosphere is the part of the earth where life exists, taking in all its living communities; a biome is one major type of community, such as a desert or a grassland.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Dr. BR Ambedkar
'Waiting for a Visa' is Dr B. R. Ambedkar's short autobiographical account of his experiences of untouchability.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Ustad Amjad Ali Khan
Ustad Amjad Ali Khan, the sarod maestro, played 'Raga for Peace' with his sons Amaan and Ayaan at the 2014 Nobel Peace Prize Concert in Oslo.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Ahmed Ali
Ahmed Ali's 'Twilight in Delhi' (1940) portrays a Muslim family of Delhi under British rule.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Violin
Lalgudi G. Jayaraman was one of the great violinists of Carnatic music.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Amitav Ghosh
Amitav Ghosh's 'Sea of Poppies' (2008) is the first novel of his Ibis trilogy.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Article 110
Article 110 defines a Money Bill; Article 109 sets out the special procedure for passing one.

Q.9 · Answer (A) SHG–Bank linkage
Under the SHG–Bank Linkage Programme, begun by NABARD in 1992, banks lend directly to self-help groups of the poor.

Q.10 · Answer (D) kinetic
The falling water's potential energy becomes kinetic energy, which turns the turbine; the generator then turns this into electrical energy.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Anai Mudi
Anai Mudi (2,695 m), in the Western Ghats of Kerala, is the highest peak in peninsular India. K2, Kangchenjunga and Kamet are in the Karakoram and the Himalaya.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Odissi
Ileana Citaristi, Italian-born and based in Bhubaneswar, received the Padma Shri in 2006 for her contribution to Odissi.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Matthias Schleiden
In 1838 Matthias Schleiden concluded that all plant tissues are made of cells; Theodor Schwann extended the idea to animals in 1839.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Ghazal
Jagjit Singh, known as the 'Ghazal King', brought the ghazal to a wide popular audience.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Uzbekistan
The 2023 Men's World Boxing Championships were held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Guru Bipin Singh
Guru Bipin Singh was one of the great gurus of Manipuri dance; he founded the Manipuri Nartanalaya in Kolkata.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel, earlier a minister in Gujarat, became Governor of Madhya Pradesh.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Inter-tropical convergence zone
The north-east and south-east trade winds meet near the equator in the Inter-tropical convergence zone (ITCZ), a belt of rising air and heavy rain.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Tanjore Balasaraswati
Tanjore Balasaraswati, the Bharatanatyam dancer, received the Padma Vibhushan in 1977.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Lekha KC
The boxer Lekha K. C. was among the 2021 recipients of the Dhyan Chand Award for lifetime achievement.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Georg Simon Ohm
Georg Simon Ohm found that the current through a metallic conductor is proportional to the potential difference across it (Ohm's law, V = IR).

Q.22 · Answer (B) Punjab
The Qila Raipur Sports Festival is held every year at Qila Raipur, near Ludhiana in Punjab.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Alitame
Alitame, developed by Pfizer in the early 1980s, is a dipeptide made from aspartic acid and alanine, about 2,000 times as sweet as sucrose; aspartame is about 200 times as sweet.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Aparna Satheesan
Aparna Satheesan, a US-based Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi dancer, received the National Institute of Indian Classical Dance's Abhinandan Saroja National Award for 2021, at a ceremony held online in November 2021.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Volleyball
The antennae on a volleyball net are flexible rods at its sides that mark the space through which the ball must cross.

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